

Steve Butterworth

Full-Stack Developer (Ruby on Rails)

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer who loves to build, as happy shaping the UI and UX as engineering what sits behind it. Ideas become working software in days, fleshed out with stakeholders and kept running in production for years. Owned the build of more than 20 Rails applications shipped to production, used by millions across web, mobile and even 30-metre long screens. Contracting since 2013, usually a long-term engagement running alongside shorter product builds.

Purpose matters to me. Being the engineer behind the UK's leading environmental job board means the code I ship helps people into green careers, and the not-for-profit co-working space I co-founded fights the isolation of remote working.

I'm happiest owning the whole loop, co-designing with non-technical stakeholders, getting a rough version in front of people for early sign-off, then supporting what ships. Years of hard live-event deadlines taught me to reach for simple solutions that hold up in production.

SKILLS

- **Programming and build:** Ruby on Rails, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo/Stimulus), Tailwind, D3.js, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, RSpec, Git/GitHub.
- **Agentic coding:** daily use of Claude Code and Codex, driven by a suite of strict SDLC skills covering task breakdown, test-first development, coding standards, and security and performance audits.
- **Prototyping and product development:** working proofs of concept in days to de-risk assumptions and win stakeholder sign-off, rough versions in front of users early and often, and quick to pick up new tools.
- **UI and UX:** often the designer as well as the developer; comfortable owning UI/UX decisions when needed.
- **Systems integration:** third-party APIs, live data feeds, browser automation and LLM services woven into products, with a bias for the least machinery that works.
- **User focus and communication:** direct daily contact with non-technical stakeholders, explaining technical trade-offs in plain English. Comfortable bridging design, product and engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Rails Developer, EnvironmentJob (contract)

2013 - Present

- Work closely with the company directors to build and maintain the UK's leading environmental jobs website.
- Sole engineer across search, advertiser and job-seeker tools, admin, CRM and reporting. Changes ship in days and stay in production for years.
- Introduced Elasticsearch full-text search with faceted filtering, and an email alert system sending over 150k emails a week.
- Created AI-powered import, clean-up and classification systems, and a tool monitoring new job postings across thousands of websites.
- Carried the platform through every upgrade from Rails 1 to Rails 8.

Founder & Developer, ChangeFlow

2023 - 2026

- Founded an AI-powered website monitoring and alerting SaaS, used by Am Law 200 firms.
- Work directly with customers to shape the product, turning requested features around in hours.
- Built LLM pipelines for classification, summarisation and data cleaning, plus an in-app AI agent.
- Now a stable, lightly maintained side product rather than an active venture.

Full-Stack Rails Developer, LEX (contract)

2019 - 2023

- Built ShotView, live 3D golf shot tracking in Three.js for The Open Championship, reaching over 1 million visits a day within 4 months.
- Turned creative concepts into working prototypes in days, then grew them into finished products.
- Created the NTT DataWall, a 30-metre live data experience in the fan villages of The Open Championship, BMW International Open and Indy 500.
- Shipped tablet and mobile apps for corporate events, incorporating live registration, feedback, live polls and games.
- Led a small engineering team within a larger multidisciplinary team including creative directors, designers and producers. Liaised with the end customer directly on requirements, feedback and support.

Full-Stack Rails Developer, GlaxoSmithKline Analytics Platform (contract, via Retechnica)

2019

- Delivered an early proof of concept in days to win sign-off, then built out medical voice-of-customer analysis, interactive visualisation and PDF/PPT export. Shipped on time and on budget, scoring 9/10 satisfaction from 50+ stakeholders.

Full-Stack Rails Developer, Pulse Group (contract)

2013 - 2018

- Developed live event data walls and public event websites in Rails/JavaScript/D3.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship.
- Delivered big live data screens for Team GB at the Olympic Games.
- Built reporting tools and touch-screen interactives for Emirates Airline.

Founder & Lead Developer, Flumes

2010 - 2013

- Founded and built a social media analytics platform from zero, collecting live social data, enriching it with third-party classification APIs and making it explorable through interactive visualisation.
- The platform became the technical foundation for later live-event work delivered for the likes of Cambridge University Press, Team GB and NTT DATA.

Full-Stack Rails Developer, AlphaSights

2008 - 2010

- Joined as first employee, set the technology direction with the founders, recruited and led the initial Rails team, and built the bespoke CRM and client portal underpinning the firm's communications.

EARLIER ROLES

- **Rails & PHP Developer, Humble Technologies** (2006 - 2008): web consultancy for UK clients.
- **Senior Software Engineer, i2 Inc. (now IBM)** (2002 - 2005): led the web version of the flagship analytics tool and built a Java/JS charting SDK.
- **Software Developer, Crystal Decisions (now SAP)** (1999 - 2001): enterprise OLAP components and a front-end JavaScript SDK, and mentored new developers.

ADDITIONAL

- **Co-Founder, Unicorn Studios Ipswich** (2019 - Present): a not-for-profit community co-working space for remote workers, freelancers and contractors.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 1st Class, University of Manchester